SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

18 October 2024 · Shift 1

78 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 12 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 14 questions

Q.1

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹2500 as a sum borrowed at 6% per year rate of interest for 6 years.

(A) 900
(B) 840
(C) 940
(D) 860

Q.4

There are five persons with weights 58 kg, 38 kg, 45 kg, 34 kg and 55 kg. What is the average weight (in kg) of those persons whose weight is less than the average weight of the five persons?

(A) 39
(B) 37
(C) 43
(D) 41

Q.5

The average of five numbers is 206. The average of two of them is 205. The average of another two of those numbers is 207.5. How many numbers can be accurately identified with this information?

(A) None
(B) Three
(C) Two
(D) One

Q.6

The average of some natural numbers is 27. If 69 is added to the first number and 12 is subtracted from the last number, the average becomes 32.7, then the number of natural numbers is:

(A) 5
(B) 8
(C) 7
(D) 10

Q.8

The price of a product increased by 20%. After some time, it decreased by 15%. What is the overall percentage change in the price?

(A) 2%
(B) 4%
(C) 1%
(D) 3%

Q.9

What is the mean proportional between 9 and 25?

(A) 34
(B) 16
(C) 15
(D) 17

Q.11

A thief is spotted by a policeman from a distance of 400 metres. When the policeman starts to chase the thief also starts running. If the speed of the thief is18km/h and that of the policeman 20 km/h, then how far would the thief have run before he is overtaken?

(A) 2.5 km
(B) 9 km
(C) 1.8 km
(D) 3.6 km

Q.12

The average weight of a family of five members (in kg) whose weights are 40 kg, 49 kg, 56 kg, 67 kg and 39 kg is:

(A) 49.2
(B) 50.2
(C) 51.2
(D) 52.2

Q.15

A shopkeeper sells a notebook that has a marked price of ₹80 at a discount of 8% and gives a pen costing ₹8.60 free with each notebook. Even then he makes a profit of 17%. Find the cost price of each note book correct to two places of decimals.

(A) ₹55.56
(B) ₹49.75
(C) ₹51.32
(D) ₹45.35

Q.16

An iron ball of radius 20 cm is melted and recast into 64 spherical balls of same radius. Find the radius of each spherical ball.

(A) 8 cm
(B) 7 cm
(C) 5 cm
(D) 6 cm

Q.17

By selling an article for ₹19.5, a dealer makes a profit of 30%. By how much should he increase his selling price (in ₹) so as to make a profit of 50%?

(A) 5
(B) 4
(C) 6
(D) 3

Q.18

x,y and z are divisible by 2,3 and 4, respectively. What is the highest common factor (HCF) of 6x,4y and 3z?

(A) At least 36
(B) At least 16
(C) At least 12
(D) At least 18

Q.19

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3500 as a sum borrowed at 7% per year rate of interest for 2 years.

(A) 450
(B) 430
(C) 490
(D) 530

Q.20

Two bicycle riders started at a speed of 7 m/sec and 8 m/sec on a circular path in opposite directions at the same point. If the circumference of the circle is 300 m, then in what time will they first meet?

(A) 12 sec
(B) 30 sec
(C) 20 sec
(D) 24 sec

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 16 questions

Q.2

What will come in place of the question mark (?) in the following equation if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 135 × 5 – 12 ÷ 11 + 8 = ?

(A) 169
(B) 136
(C) 121
(D) 151

Q.3

What will come in the place of '?' in the following equation, if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 4 ÷ 8 × 2 – 7 +3 = ?

(A) 16
(B) 18
(C) 20
(D) 15

Q.4

HOJF is related to IPKG in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, KRMI is related to LSNJ. To which of the following is MTOK related following the same logic?

(A) NUPL
(B) UNPL
(C) UNLP
(D) NULP

Q.5

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: No child is a man. No man is an adult. Conclusions: (I) Some men are child. (II) No child is an adult.

(A) Only conclusion I follows
(B) Both conclusions I and II follow
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Neither conclusion I nor II follow

Q.6

KPMI is related to LQNJ in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, NSPL is related to OTQM. To which of the following is RWTP related, following the same logic?

(A) SXUQ
(B) XSQU
(C) SXQU
(D) XSUQ

Q.7

In a certain code language, 'SAND' is coded as '2468' and 'WEST' is coded as '3574'. What is the code for 'S' in the given code language?

(A) 2
(B) 8
(C) 4
(D) 7

Q.8

In a certain code language, 'does she hear' is written as 'mt sp dt' and 'hear the music' is written as 'rb mt ch'. What is the code for 'hear' in that language?

(A) sp
(B) mt
(C) ch
(D) rb

Q.9

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series based on the English alphabetical order? DXZ, HTV ,LPR ,PLN, ?

(A) THJ
(B) THK
(C) SHK
(D) SHJ

Q.10

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying etc. to 13, can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) (8, 38, 11) (3, 20, 7)

(A) (3, 20, 5)
(B) (4, 14, 2)
(C) (2, 52, 32)
(D) (1, 26, 12)

Q.11

In a certain code language, 'BOAT' is coded as '5197' and 'AIRS' is coded as '2418'. What is the code for 'A' in the given code language?

(A) 1
(B) 4
(C) 2
(D) 9

Q.13

Six boys A, B, C, D, E and F sit around a circular table facing towards the centre (not necessarily in the same order). Two boys sit between B and F when counted either from the right or left of B. One boy sits between A and B when counted from the right of A. E sits second to the left of A. D sits second to the left of C. Which of the following statement(s) is/are not correct? I. A is an immediate neighbour of D. II. C is an immediate neighbour of F.

(A) Only I
(B) Neither I nor II
(C) Both I and II
(D) Only II

Q.14

15 is related to 92 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 18 is related to 110. To which of the following is 7 related, following the same logic? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 67
(B) 56
(C) 44
(D) 76

Q.15

U, V, W, X, Y, Z and A are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). Only three people sit between X and Y when counted from the left of X. Only three people sit between Z and U when counted from the right of U. V sits to the immediate right of Z. W is an immediate neighbour of U as well as Y. Who sits to the second to the left of A?

(A) Y
(B) Z
(C) U
(D) W

Q.17

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All bowling are billiards. Some billiards are not chess. Conclusions: [1] All chess are bowling. [2] All billiards are chess.

(A) Neither conclusion [1] nor [2] follows
(B) Only conclusion [2] follows
(C) Both conclusions [1] and [2] follow
(D) Only conclusion [1] follows

Q.18

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the following series? 4, 10 ,28, 82, 244, ?

(A) 732
(B) 731
(C) 734
(D) 730

Q.20

In a certain code language, 'will you go' is written as 'ht dt gt' and 'you can go' is written as 'gt st dt'. How will 'can' be written in the given code language?

(A) ht
(B) dt
(C) gt
(D) st

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

In May 2023, the Union Housing and Urban Affairs Ministry has extended the deadline of its Smart Cities Mission to _____.

(A) June 2025
(B) June 2026
(C) June 2027
(D) June 2024

Q.2

Which of the following cultural festivals of Himachal Pradesh is organised on the auspicious occasion of Basant Panchami at Hadimba Temple?

(A) Bisua
(B) Mopin
(C) Ziro
(D) Doongri

Q.3

At which of the following places was the Indian Civil Service Examination held for the first time in India?

(A) Allahabad
(B) Surat
(C) Delhi
(D) Calcutta

Q.4

'Ace Against Odds' is the autobiography of a sports personality playing the game of _____.

(A) Tennis
(B) Badminton
(C) Cricket
(D) Shooting

Q.5

Which inorganic compound is known to undergo solid state reaction to form urea?

(A) Ammonium acetate
(B) Ammonium phosphate
(C) Ammonium nitrate
(D) Ammonium cyanate

Q.6

The Pitti Bird Sanctuary is located in which Union Territory/State of India?

(A) Manipur
(B) Lakshadweep
(C) Andaman and Nicobar Islands
(D) Tamil Nadu

Q.7

Sunil Chhetri made history by becoming the first Indian to score a hat-trick in the Hero ISL, which came in the _____ edition.

(A) 2016
(B) 2013
(C) 2014
(D) 2015

Q.8
In which of the following years was the Child Marriage Restraint Act passed?

(A) 1929
(B) 1872
(C) 1856
(D) 1902

Q.9
The classical dance form ‘Kathakali’ traces its origin to which of the following states of India?

(A) Odisha
(B) Kerala
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Andhra Pradesh

Q.10
Which of the following is the first event in a triathlon?

(A) Putting the shot
(B) Running
(C) Swimming
(D) Cycling

Q.11
Article 157 of the Constitution of India mentions the qualifications required for appointment of the _____ of a State.

(A) Election Commissioner
(B) Governor
(C) Chief Minister
(D) Chief Justice of High Court

Q.12
The excavated ruins of the Nalanda University indicate that bright red _____ was/were used in its construction.

(A) bricks
(B) stone
(C) marble
(D) granite

Q.13
Where was the Hindustani classical singer Kumar Gandharva born?

(A) Tamil Nadu
(B) Tripura
(C) Odisha
(D) Karnataka

Q.14
What is the primary function of the excretory system in animals?

(A) Removal of waste products
(B) Digestion
(C) Reproduction
(D) Respiration

Q.15
Which of the following is NOT an example of public goods?

(A) Driveway at our home
(B) Access to clean air
(C) Law enforcement
(D) National defence

Q.16
With reference to agriculture in India, the term 'penda' is the name given to _____.

(A) slash and burn agriculture
(B) plantation agriculture
(C) tea farming
(D) agricultural season

Q.17
Who among the following scholars gave reference to the history of Kashmir?

(A) Harsha
(B) Kalidas
(C) Banbhatta
(D) Kalhana

Q.18

The author of 'Arthashastra' was a contemporary of which of the following rulers?

(A) Ashoka
(B) Samudragupta
(C) Chandragupta Vikramaditya
(D) Chandragupta Maurya

Q.19

Despite being eligible for the job of a Legal Officer, Mr. X was not called for an interview for the aforementioned post. Which of his rights was Mr. X unable to exercise?

(A) Protection against arrest
(B) Equality before law
(C) Right to education
(D) Equality of opportunity

Q.20

Which of the following factors is primarily responsible for soil formation?

(A) Mining
(B) Irrigation
(C) Weathering
(D) Degradation

Q.21

Shovana Narayan, a Padma Shri recipient, is an exponent of _____.

(A) Kuchipudi
(B) Kathak
(C) Bharatanatyam
(D) Sattriya

Q.22

According to sympatric speciation, the rising of a new species occurs when:

(A) organisms from the same species start to show different behavioural characteristics
(B) one species is separated into different groups due to geologic events like mountain formation
(C) the two groups of organisms from the same species would phenotypically look different
(D) two groups of the same species cannot interbreed among themselves despite living in the same geographic location

Q.23

Which of the following states has the lowest child sex ratio according to Census of India, 2001?

(A) Uttarakhand
(B) Haryana
(C) Himachal Pradesh
(D) Kerala

Q.24

In January 2023, three Indian-origin researchers were among nine scientists named recipients of the Blavatnik Awardsfor Young Scientists in the UK. Which of the following is NOT one of these three scientists?

(A) Mehul Malik
(B) Gagandeep Kang
(C) Tanmay Bharat
(D) Rahul R Nair

Q.25

As per Census 2011, which of the following states recorded negative growth in child sex ratio?

(A) Punjab
(B) Maharashtra
(C) Himachal Pradesh
(D) Haryana

English Language and Comprehension 23 questions

Q.1

Which of the following sentences contains an adverbial error?

(A) She writes slowly and steadily.
(B) The teacher spoke clear and concise.
(C) They danced gracefully across the stage.
(D) He sang beautifully at the talent show.

Q.2

Read the following sentence and select its future tense form from the options given below: Ramya finished her dissertation early.

(A) Ramya is finishing her dissertation early.
(B) Ramya had finished her dissertation early.
(C) Ramya has finished her dissertation early.
(D) Ramya will finish her dissertation early.

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. David decided to _____ his old boat to get a new one.

(A) cell
(B) sale
(C) sell
(D) ceil

Q.5

In the following sentence the underlined part contains an error. Alternatives to the underlined part are given as options. Select the correct alternative. Yesterday was the “worse” day of my life.

(A) bad
(B) worst
(C) most bad
(D) ill

Q.6

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Abandoned
(B) Dangerous
(C) Celibrate
(D) Excellent

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. The branches of the tree “is” very long.

(A) had
(B) was
(C) are
(D) has

Q.8

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. He received the best employee award because he was the “more hardworking”.

(A) hardworking
(B) No improvement required
(C) the hardworking
(D) most hardworking

Q.9

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The Chinese government has accepted slower economic development as the ‘new normal’, recognising the need for China to adopt a new growth model that depends less on fixed investment and exports and more on private consumption, services, and innovation to _____ economic growth.

(A) drive
(B) bridle
(C) exhale
(D) success

Q.10

Select the correct option of the given sentence. Smt. Savithri is wisest than all others in the group.

(A) Smt. Savithri is wise than all others in the group.
(B) Smt. Savithri is the wise than all others in the group.
(C) Smt. Savithri is wiser than all others in the group.
(D) Smt. Savithri is the wiser than all others in the group.

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. He possesses one of the “slimmer” handsets in the world.

(A) most slim
(B) slim
(C) slimmest
(D) most slimmest

Q.12

Select the word that has the same meaning (SYNONYM) as the underlined word in the given sentence. The teacher made “judicious” use of technology to explain a sensitive topic.

(A) judgmental
(B) difficult
(C) prudent
(D) prominent

Q.13

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word provided in the brackets to fill in the blank. The painting exhibited a _____ blend of colours. (harmonious)

(A) polyphonic
(B) discordant
(C) quavering
(D) thrilling

Q.15

Select the appropriate meaning of the given idiom. At the drop of a hat

(A) Crying without any reason
(B) Willingness to do something instantly
(C) Reveal a secret carelessly
(D) Become easily frightened

Q.16

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The teacher asked the students to stay _____ during the exam.

(A) quit
(B) quote
(C) quiet
(D) quite

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Due to _____ 'eve teasing', parents conclude that it is not worth the danger of sending their daughters to school.

(A) narrow
(B) localised
(C) widespread
(D) rectified

Q.18

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word..

(A) separate
(B) resistance
(C) weather
(D) tendancy

Q.19

select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank to complete the idiom and make the sentence meaningful. During the interview, the candidate was challenged to provide chapter and _____ on his proposed plan.

(A) cover
(B) verse
(C) lines
(D) page

Q.20

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. The place where soldiers live

(A) Unit
(B) Barracks
(C) Regiment
(D) Brigade

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It is the mad (1)_____ for speed that is responsible for many motor accidents. Only last year, I (2)_____ what might have been a (3)_____ accident on Kashmir Road. I was motoring down (4)_____ Srinagar; and as I was nearing Kohala, I came upon the (5)_____ of two cars on the road.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) boredom
(B) block
(C) luck
(D) craze

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It is the mad (1)_____ for speed that is responsible for many motor accidents. Only last year, I (2)_____ what might have been a (3)_____ accident on Kashmir Road. I was motoring down (4)_____ Srinagar; and as I was nearing Kohala, I came upon the (5)_____ of two cars on the road.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) checked
(B) witnessed
(C) argued
(D) anticipated

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It is the mad (1)_____ for speed that is responsible for many motor accidents. Only last year, I (2)_____ what might have been a (3)_____ accident on Kashmir Road. I was motoring down (4)_____ Srinagar; and as I was nearing Kohala, I came upon the (5)_____ of two cars on the road.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) happening
(B) harmless
(C) wonderful
(D) fatal

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It is the mad (1)_____ for speed that is responsible for many motor accidents. Only last year, I (2)_____ what might have been a (3)_____ accident on Kashmir Road. I was motoring down (4)_____ Srinagar; and as I was nearing Kohala, I came upon the (5)_____ of two cars on the road.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) on
(B) from
(C) since
(D) besides

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. It is the mad (1)_____ for speed that is responsible for many motor accidents. Only last year, I (2)_____ what might have been a (3)_____ accident on Kashmir Road. I was motoring down (4)_____ Srinagar; and as I was nearing Kohala, I came upon the (5)_____ of two cars on the road.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) cluster
(B) pile
(C) collision
(D) clatter

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**
Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**				

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.7 **(C)**
Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(C)**
Q.15 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.20 **(D)**		

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(C)**
Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(B)**
Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**
Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(C)**	

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 · Answer (A) 900

SI = 2,500 × 6 × 6/100 = ₹900.

Q.4 · Answer (A) 39

The five weigh 230 kg in all, an average of 46 kg. Those below it weigh 38, 45 and 34 kg: 117/3 = 39 kg.

Q.5 · Answer (D) One

The five total 5 × 206 = 1,030 and the two pairs 2 × 205 = 410 and 2 × 207.5 = 415. Only the fifth number can be found: 1,030 − 410 − 415 = 205.

Q.6 · Answer (D) 10

The total rises by 69 − 12 = 57, which raises the average by 32.7 − 27 = 5.7. So there are 57/5.7 = 10 numbers.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 2%

1.2 × 0.85 = 1.02, so the price rises by 2% overall.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 15

The mean proportional of a and b is √(ab): √(9 × 25) = √225 = 15.

Q.11 · Answer (D) 3.6 km

The policeman gains 20 − 18 = 2 km/h, so he closes the 0.4 km in 0.2 hours. In that time the thief runs 18 × 0.2 = 3.6 km.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 50.2

(40 + 49 + 56 + 67 + 39)/5 = 251/5 = 50.2 kg.

Q.15 · Answer (A) ₹55.56

The selling price is 0.92 × 80 = ₹73.60. Less the ₹8.60 pen, he gets ₹65 for the notebook, which is 117% of its cost: 65/1.17 = ₹55.56.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 5 cm

The volume is unchanged: $20^3 = 64r^3$, so $r^3 = 8{,}000/64 = 125$ and r = 5 cm.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 3

Cost price = 19.5/1.3 = ₹15. A 50% profit needs 1.5 × 15 = ₹22.50, an increase of ₹3.

Q.18 · Answer (C) At least 12

With x = 2a, y = 3b and z = 4c, 6x = 12a, 4y = 12b and 3z = 12c. All three are multiples of 12, so their HCF is at least 12.

Q.19 · Answer (C) 490

SI = 3,500 × 7 × 2/100 = ₹490.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 20 sec

Riding in opposite directions they close the 300 m together at 7 + 8 = 15 m/s: 300/15 = 20 seconds.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.2 · Answer (D) 151

After interchanging the signs: 135 ÷ 5 + 12 × 11 − 8 = 27 + 132 − 8 = 151.

Q.3 · Answer (C) 20

After interchanging the signs: 4 × 8 ÷ 2 + 7 − 3 = 16 + 7 − 3 = 20.

Q.4 · Answer (A) NUPL

Each letter moves one place forward: H → I, O → P, J → K, F → G. So MTOK → NUPL.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Neither conclusion I nor II follow
No child is a man, so no man is a child and I is false. Two negative statements say nothing about children and adults, so II does not follow either.

Q.6 · Answer (A) SXUQ
Each letter moves one place forward: K → L, P → Q, M → N, I → J. So RWTP → SXUQ.

Q.7 · Answer (C) 4
S is the only letter in both words and 4 the only digit in both codes, so S = 4.

Q.8 · Answer (B) mt
'hear' is the only word in both sentences and 'mt' the only code in both, so hear = mt.

Q.9 · Answer (A) THJ
First letters move 4 places forward (D, H, L, P, T), second letters 4 back (X, T, P, L, H) and third letters 4 back (Z, V, R, N, J): THJ.

Q.10 · Answer (D) (1, 26, 12)
The middle number is twice the sum of the other two: 2 × (8 + 11) = 38 and 2 × (3 + 7) = 20. Likewise 2 × (1 + 12) = 26.

Q.11 · Answer (A) 1
A is the only letter in both words and 1 the only digit in both codes, so A = 1.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Only II
B and F sit opposite. B is second to A's right, so A is second to B's left; E is second to A's left, and D second to C's left puts C and D in the last two seats. Going round to each boy's left: B, D, A, F, E, C. A sits next to D, so I is correct; C sits between E and B, not next to F, so II is not.

Q.14 · Answer (C) 44
Each number is multiplied by 6 and 2 added: 15 × 6 + 2 = 92 and 18 × 6 + 2 = 110. So 7 × 6 + 2 = 44.

Q.15 · Answer (D) W
Y is fourth to X's left and W sits between U and Y. With U and W on Y's right, Z (fourth to U's right) would have Y on its immediate right, V's seat, so W and U are on Y's left. Going round to each person's left from X: X, V, Z, A, Y, W, U. Second to the left of A is W.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Neither conclusion [1] nor [2] follows
Nothing makes every chess a bowling, so [1] does not follow; some billiards are not chess, so [2], 'all billiards are chess', is false.

Q.18 · Answer (D) 730
Each term is three times the one before minus 2: 82 × 3 − 2 = 244 and 244 × 3 − 2 = 730.

Q.20 · Answer (D) st
'you' and 'go' are in both sentences and 'dt' and 'gt' in both codes, so 'can' is the code left in the second: st.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) June 2024
In May 2023 the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs extended the Smart Cities Mission's deadline to June 2024.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Doongri
SSC's key gives Doongri, the festival of the Hadimba Devi temple in Manali, which stands in the Doongri forest. Mopin and the Ziro music festival belong to Arunachal Pradesh.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Allahabad
The ICS examination was first held in India, alongside London, at Allahabad in 1922.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Tennis
'Ace Against Odds' (2016) is the autobiography of the tennis player Sania Mirza.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Ammonium cyanate
Ammonium cyanate rearranges into urea, its isomer, when heated: Friedrich Wöhler's synthesis of urea in 1828.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Lakshadweep
Pitti, an uninhabited islet of Lakshadweep, is a sanctuary for nesting sea birds such as terns.

Q.7 · Answer (D) 2015
On 28 October 2015, in Mumbai City FC's 5–1 win over NorthEast United, Sunil Chhetri scored the first ISL hat-trick by an Indian.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 1929
The Child Marriage Restraint Act, known as the Sarda Act, was passed in 1929.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Kerala
Kathakali, the dance drama known for its elaborate make-up and costumes, comes from Kerala.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Swimming
A triathlon is swimming, cycling and running, in that order.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Governor
Under Article 157 a Governor must be a citizen of India who has completed 35 years of age.

Q.12 · Answer (A) bricks
The excavated monasteries and temples of Nalanda are built of red brick.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Karnataka
Kumar Gandharva (Shivaputra Komkalimath) was born in 1924 at Sulebhavi near Belgaum (Belagavi), Karnataka.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Removal of waste products
The excretory system removes the body's nitrogenous wastes, with excess water and salts.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Driveway at our home
Public goods are open to all, and one person's use does not reduce another's: clean air, law enforcement, national defence. A driveway at one's home is private.

Q.16 · Answer (A) slash and burn agriculture
NCERT lists 'Podu' or 'Penda' as the names for slash and burn (shifting) agriculture in Andhra Pradesh.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Kalhana
Kalhana's 'Rajatarangini' (12th century) is a chronicle of the kings of Kashmir.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Chandragupta Maurya
The 'Arthashastra' is attributed to Kautilya (Chanakya), Chandragupta Maurya's minister.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Equality of opportunity
Article 16 guarantees equality of opportunity in public employment, which an eligible candidate kept from the interview is denied.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Weathering
Soil forms from rock broken down by weathering, physical, chemical and biological.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Kathak
Shovana Narayan is a leading Kathak dancer.

Q.22 · Answer (D) two groups of the same species cannot interbreed among themselves despite living in the same geographic location
In sympatric speciation groups living in the same area become reproductively isolated, without any geographic barrier. Separation by mountains or other barriers is allopatric speciation.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Haryana
In Census 2001 Haryana's child sex ratio, 819 girls per 1,000 boys, was the lowest in India after Punjab's (798).

Q.24 · Answer (B) Gagandeep Kang
Rahul R Nair (laureate), Mehul Malik and Tanmay Bharat (finalists) were the three Indian-origin scientists among the nine honoured; the awards were in fact announced in January 2024, for 2024. Gagandeep Kang is an Indian virologist.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Maharashtra
Between Census 2001 and 2011 Maharashtra's child sex ratio fell, while those of Punjab, Haryana and Himachal Pradesh rose.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (B) The teacher spoke clear and concise.
Verbs are modified by adverbs: 'spoke clearly and concisely', not 'clear and concise'.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Ramya will finish her dissertation early.
The simple future of 'finished' is 'will finish'.

Q.3 · Answer (C) sell
To 'sell' the boat is to part with it for money; 'sale' is the noun, and 'cell' only sounds the same.

Q.5 · Answer (B) worst
Comparing one day with all the others needs the superlative: 'the worst day of my life'.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Celibrate
The correct spelling is 'Celebrate'.

Q.7 · Answer (C) are
The plural subject 'branches' takes the plural verb 'are'.

Q.8 · Answer (D) most hardworking
Being the best of all the employees needs the superlative: 'the most hardworking'.

Q.9 · Answer (A) drive
Consumption, services and innovation are to 'drive', that is power, economic growth.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Smt. Savithri is wiser than all others in the group.
A comparison with 'than' takes the comparative: 'wiser than all others'.

Q.11 · Answer (C) slimmest
'One of the' is followed by a superlative: 'one of the slimmest handsets'.

Q.12 · Answer (C) prudent
'Judicious' means showing good judgement: 'prudent'.

Q.13 · Answer (B) discordant
'Harmonious' means pleasingly combined; its opposite is 'discordant', clashing.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Willingness to do something instantly
To do something 'at the drop of a hat' is to do it at once, without hesitation.

Q.16 · Answer (C) quiet
'Quiet' means silent; 'quite', 'quit' and 'quote' only look or sound similar.

Q.17 · Answer (C) widespread
It is eve teasing that is 'widespread', found everywhere, that makes parents think school not worth the danger.

Q.18 · Answer (D) tendancy
The correct spelling is 'tendency'.

Q.19 · Answer (B) verse
'Chapter and verse' means the exact details or authority for something.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Barracks
Barracks are the buildings in which soldiers live.

Q.21 · Answer (D) craze
A 'craze' is a passion or obsession: the mad craze for speed.

Q.22 · Answer (B) witnessed
The writer 'witnessed', that is saw, what might have been an accident.

Q.23 · Answer (D) fatal
What 'might have been a fatal accident' is one that could have killed.

Q.24 · Answer (B) from
The writer was motoring down 'from' Srinagar, the starting point, and was nearing Kohala.

Q.25 · Answer (C) collision
He came upon the 'collision', the crash, of two cars.

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